



ROLE-BASED GUIDE FOR JOURNAL MANAGEMENT SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT

Functional Requirements, Workflow, Permissions, and Operating Procedures

Proposed Version 1.0 | 2026

Document Information	Description
Purpose	Guide the developer in designing the journal management system and guide users in performing role-specific tasks.
Primary Roles	Editor-in-Chief, Managing Editor, Section Editor, Reviewer, and Author
Submission Package	Four-file author submission package
Review Model	Double-blind peer review
Publication Frequency	Biannual: June and December
Institution	Sultan Kudarat State University

Important: Items marked [TO BE APPROVED] require formal confirmation by the Editorial Board before system configuration.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Version	Date	Description	Status
1.0	2026	Initial role-based functional guide for system development	Proposed

This document translates the proposed SKRJET editorial policies into role-specific procedures and system requirements. It is intended for the journal management team, system developer, and future administrators.

1. PURPOSE AND INTENDED USE

This guide ensures that the SKRJET journal management system reflects the actual responsibilities of each participant in the editorial and publication process. It should be used for functional requirements, interface design, access control, workflow configuration, testing, training, and system improvement.

- Authors submit and monitor manuscripts.
- Reviewers evaluate assigned manuscripts.
- Section Editors manage manuscripts within their subject area.
- Managing Editors coordinate technical processing, communications, and production.
- The Editor-in-Chief exercises overall editorial authority and makes or confirms final decisions.

2. SYSTEM DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- Role-based access control.
- Double-blind review and controlled file visibility.
- Complete audit trail for important actions.
- Version control for all uploaded documents.
- No skipping of required workflow stages without authorized override.
- Protection of unpublished manuscripts and personal information.
- Clear author-facing status updates.
- Accessible, responsive, and user-friendly design.
- Configurable article types, deadlines, templates, and decision labels.

3. USER ROLES AND ACCESS LEVELS

Role	Primary Function	Main Permissions
Author	Submit and revise manuscripts	Create submission, upload files, enter metadata, respond to decisions, track status
Reviewer	Provide independent scholarly evaluation	Accept/decline invitation, view anonymized manuscript, complete review, submit recommendation
Section Editor	Manage manuscripts in assigned subject area	Screen, invite reviewers, monitor reviews, recommend decisions
Managing Editor	Coordinate editorial operations	Check completeness, manage files/metadata, communicate, monitor workflow, coordinate production
Editor-in-Chief	Exercise final editorial authority	Assign editors, approve decisions, resolve conflicts, approve publication

System Administrator	Maintain technical system	Manage accounts, configuration, backups, and technical support
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4. OVERALL EDITORIAL WORKFLOW

1. Author creates account and starts submission.
2. Author selects article type, enters metadata, accepts declarations, and uploads required files.
3. Managing Editor conducts technical completeness check.
4. Editor-in-Chief or Managing Editor assigns Section Editor.
5. Section Editor conducts scope and preliminary scholarly screening.
6. Section Editor invites qualified reviewers.
7. Reviewers accept or decline invitations.
8. Reviewers submit reports and recommendations.
9. Section Editor evaluates reports and recommends a decision.
10. Editor-in-Chief confirms or changes the decision.
11. Author receives decision letter.
12. Author submits revision and response to reviewers when required.
13. Accepted manuscripts proceed to copyediting, layout, proofreading, and publication.
14. Editor-in-Chief approves the final article or issue.

Submission → Technical Check → Editorial Screening → Reviewer Assignment → Peer Review → Editorial Decision → Revision, if required → Acceptance → Production → Publication

5. AUTHOR GUIDE

5.1 Author Account and Profile

- Full name
- Email address
- Institution and department
- Country
- ORCID iD, if available
- Professional affiliation
- Contact details
- Username and password
- Consent to receive journal communications

5.2 Starting a New Submission

15. Select New Submission.
16. Select article type.
17. Confirm scope, originality, and exclusive submission.
18. Complete ethics, funding, conflict-of-interest, AI-use, and data-availability declarations as applicable.
19. Enter manuscript metadata.
20. Add all authors in correct order.
21. Upload the required files.
22. Review the submission summary.
23. Submit the manuscript.

5.3 Required Four-File Submission Package

The system must require or clearly identify the following files:

File	Required Content	Visibility	Validation
File 1 — Cover Letter	Originality statement, contribution, ethics, funding, conflicts, and confirmation that all authors approved.	Editorial team only	Required
File 2 — Title Page	Full title, author names, affiliations, ORCID iDs, corresponding-author details, funding, conflicts, ethics, and identifying information.	Editorial team only	Required
File 3 — Anonymous Manuscript	Main manuscript without author names, affiliations, acknowledgments, identifying institutional references, or revealing metadata.	Reviewers and editorial team	Required
File 4 — Supplementary Materials, if applicable	Datasets, instruments, appendices, additional tables/figures, protocols, code, or supporting files.	Authorized users according to file type	Optional unless required

Developer requirement: The upload interface must label each file clearly and must prevent or warn against uploading the Title Page as the Anonymous Manuscript.

5.4 File Naming Convention

- Surname_CoverLetter.docx
- Surname_TitlePage.docx
- Anonymous_Manuscript.docx
- Surname_Supplementary_01.pdf
- Surname_Supplementary_02.xlsx

5.5 Author Metadata Form

- Article title
- Article type
- Abstract
- Keywords
- Author names and order
- Affiliations
- Corresponding author
- Email address
- ORCID iDs
- Funding statement
- Conflict of interest statement
- Ethics statement
- Informed consent statement, if applicable
- AI use disclosure, if applicable
- Data availability statement, if applicable

- Related publication disclosure

5.6 Author Declarations

- Manuscript is original.
- Not simultaneously submitted elsewhere.
- All authors approved the final version and author order.
- Ethical requirements were observed.
- Sources are properly cited.
- Funding and conflicts are disclosed.
- AI use is disclosed where applicable.
- Copyright and licensing terms are accepted.

5.7 Author Dashboard

- Submission ID and title
- Article type and submission date
- Current status and editorial stage
- Required action
- Decision letter
- Revision deadline
- File versions
- Messages
- Submit revision
- Withdraw submission, subject to policy

5.8 Author Revision Process

24. Receive decision letter.
25. Download reviewer comments.
26. Prepare revised manuscript.
27. Prepare Response to Reviewers.
28. Upload revised manuscript, response, and updated supplementary materials.
29. Confirm author approval.
30. Submit before deadline.

The original submission and every revision must remain accessible through version history. Revised files must not silently replace earlier files.

6. REVIEWER GUIDE

6.1 Reviewer Profile

- Name
- Institution
- Discipline
- Email
- Areas of expertise
- Keywords
- ORCID iD, if available
- Availability

- Conflict-of-interest declaration
- Review history for authorized editors

6.2 Reviewer Invitation Workflow

31. Receive invitation.
32. View limited manuscript information.
33. Declare conflict of interest.
34. Accept or decline.
35. If accepted, access anonymized manuscript and review form.
36. Submit review before deadline.

6.3 Reviewer Access

- Anonymous Manuscript
- Relevant supplementary materials
- Review guidelines
- Review form
- Recommendation options
- Confidential comments to editor
- Comments to author
- Annotated manuscript upload, if allowed
- Deadline and confirmation

Reviewers must not see author names, Title Page, Cover Letter, other reviewer identities, other reviewer reports, internal editorial notes, or confidential decision discussions.

6.4 Reviewer Evaluation Form

Criterion	Suggested Response
Scope relevance	Yes / No / Partly
Originality	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor
Significance	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor
Theory/conceptual grounding	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor / N/A
Methodological rigor	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor
Ethics	Satisfactory / Needs clarification / Unsatisfactory / N/A
Results	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor
Discussion	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor
References	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor
Presentation	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor
Overall recommendation	Accept / Minor Revision / Major Revision / Reject

The form must include separate text boxes for comments to the author and confidential comments to the editor.

6.5 Reviewer Ethics

- Treat manuscripts as confidential.
- Disclose conflicts.
- Do not use unpublished information for personal advantage.
- Provide respectful and evidence-based comments.
- Do not manipulate citations.
- Do not expose confidential manuscript content to unauthorized AI tools.

7. SECTION EDITOR GUIDE

- Manage assigned manuscripts.
- Assess scope and preliminary quality.
- Select qualified reviewers.
- Monitor invitations and deadlines.
- Evaluate reports.
- Request additional review when needed.
- Recommend decisions.
- Maintain fairness, confidentiality, and integrity.

7.1 Screening Workflow

37. Open manuscript record.
38. Review title, abstract, keywords, and article type.
39. Confirm section relevance.
40. Check Anonymous Manuscript and basic ethics information.
41. Identify serious deficiencies or integrity concerns.
42. Record screening note.
43. Return for correction, reject without review, or proceed to reviewer selection.

7.2 Reviewer Selection

- Search by discipline, keywords, institution, country, availability, conflict status, active assignments, and review history.
- Prevent or warn against conflicts, same-institution assignments, and excessive workloads.

7.3 Recommendation Workflow

44. Review all reports.
45. Assess agreement or contradiction.
46. Request additional review if necessary.
47. Evaluate revision and author responses.
48. Prepare recommendation and rationale.
49. Submit to Editor-in-Chief.

8. MANAGING EDITOR GUIDE

- Manage submission intake and technical completeness.
- Maintain records and metadata.
- Coordinate communications.
- Assign manuscripts as directed.
- Check anonymization.
- Prepare decision letters.
- Coordinate revisions, copyediting, layout, proofreading, and publication.
- Maintain issue records.

8.1 Initial Technical Check

Check	System Action if Incomplete
Four-file package	Flag missing file and return to author
File formats	Reject unsupported format or request replacement

Anonymous manuscript	Flag author-identifying information
Title Page	Confirm author details
Metadata	Flag missing title, abstract, keywords, or authors
Declarations	Require completion
Ethics information	Flag missing or inconsistent statement
Similarity screening	Record result for authorized review
Formatting/language	Return for correction when necessary

8.2 Communication Templates

- Submission received
- Incomplete submission
- Technical correction requested
- Assignment notice
- Reviewer invitation
- Reviewer reminder
- Overdue review
- Decision letters
- Revision reminder
- Acceptance confirmation
- Proofreading request
- Publication notification

8.3 Production Tasks

50. Confirm final accepted manuscript.
51. Check metadata and author information.
52. Coordinate copyediting.
53. Coordinate layout and typesetting.
54. Send proof to corresponding author.
55. Record corrections.
56. Obtain final approval.
57. Prepare issue table of contents.
58. Finalize metadata and archive files.

9. EDITOR-IN-CHIEF GUIDE

- Provide editorial leadership.
- Approve policies and workflows.
- Assign Section Editors.
- Ensure fairness and independence.
- Make or confirm final decisions.
- Resolve conflicts and appeals.
- Approve reviewers and editorial appointments.
- Approve accepted manuscripts and issues.
- Oversee corrections, retractions, and expressions of concern.

9.1 Final Decision Workflow

59. Review Section Editor recommendation.
60. Review reviewer reports and author responses.

61. Assess scholarly and ethical suitability.
62. Select or confirm decision.
63. Approve rationale and release decision letter.
64. Authorize production for accepted manuscripts.

9.2 Appeals

The system should provide an appeal form containing submission ID, appeal reason, specific concern, supporting evidence, and date. The Editor-in-Chief may review the appeal or assign an independent editor. The original decision and appeal record must be preserved.

10. FILE AND DOCUMENT REQUIREMENTS

Document	Uploader	Visible To	Versioned?	Stage
Cover Letter	Author	Editors	Yes	Submission
Title Page	Author	Editors	Yes	Submission
Anonymous Manuscript	Author	Editors and reviewers	Yes	Submission/Review
Supplementary Materials	Author	Authorized users	Yes	Submission/Review
Reviewer Report	Reviewer	Editors	Yes	Peer Review
Decision Letter	Editor/Managing Editor	Author and editors	Yes	Decision
Response to Reviewers	Author	Editors	Yes	Revision
Copyedited Manuscript	Production team	Editorial team	Yes	Production
Proof	Production team	Author and editors	Yes	Proofreading
Final Article	Managing Editor	Public	Yes	Publication

11. MANUSCRIPT STATUSES

Status	Meaning
Draft	Author has started but not submitted
Submitted	Submission received
Technical Check	Completeness and format are checked
Returned for Technical Correction	Author must correct deficiencies
Awaiting Section Editor	Awaiting assignment
Editorial Screening	Scope and preliminary quality assessment
Reviewer Invitation	Reviewers are being invited
Under Review	Reviews are active
Reviews Complete	Required reports received
Decision Pending	Decision being prepared
Revision Required	Author must revise
Revision Submitted	Revision received
Accepted	Accepted by authorized editor
Copyediting	Language/style editing
Layout and Typesetting	Publication formatting
Proofreading	Proof is being checked
Ready for Publication	Final files approved
Published	Publicly available
Rejected	Will not proceed
Withdrawn	Withdrawn under policy

Archived	Record retained
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12. NOTIFICATIONS AND COMMUNICATION

Trigger	Recipient	Notification
Submission completed	Author/Managing Editor	Submission received
Missing file	Author	Technical correction required
Assignment	Section Editor	New manuscript assigned
Reviewer invitation	Reviewer	Invitation and deadline
Invitation response	Editors	Accepted or declined
Review overdue	Reviewer/Section Editor	Reminder
Review submitted	Section Editor/Managing Editor	Review received
Decision released	Author	Decision letter available
Revision deadline	Author/Editor	Revision reminder
Acceptance	Author/Managing Editor	Production initiated
Proof available	Author	Proofreading required
Publication	Author/Editorial Board	Article published

13. DOUBLE-BLIND REVIEW REQUIREMENTS

- Reviewers never see author names or Title Page.
- Authors never see reviewer names unless open review is formally adopted.
- Internal notes are never visible to authors or reviewers.
- File metadata must be checked.
- Editors receive a visibility warning before releasing files.
- Visibility overrides require authorization and a recorded reason.

14. DECISION AND REVISION WORKFLOW

14.1 Decision Letter Components

- Submission ID and title
- Decision label
- Editorial summary
- Reviewer comments to author
- Revision instructions and deadline
- Resubmission instructions
- Confidential notes excluded from author copy

14.2 Revision Package

- Revised Anonymous Manuscript
- Response to Reviewers
- Updated Supplementary Materials, if applicable
- Updated declarations, if required

15. PRODUCTION AND PUBLICATION WORKFLOW

65. Transfer accepted manuscript to production.

66. Confirm metadata and files.
67. Complete copyediting.
68. Resolve author queries.
69. Complete layout.
70. Send proof.
71. Receive corrections.
72. Approve final proof.
73. Finalize metadata, DOI, ISSN/eISSN, volume, issue, and article identifiers when available.
74. Publish and archive final files.

16. AUDIT TRAIL AND RECORDS MANAGEMENT

- Creation and submission dates
- User and timestamp for every action
- Status changes
- File uploads and versions
- Reviewer invitations and responses
- Review reports
- Recommendations and decisions
- Decision-letter versions
- Revision history
- Production milestones
- Publication date
- Withdrawals, corrections, and retractions

17. DATA PRIVACY AND SECURITY

- Secure authentication
- Role-based access
- Protection of unpublished manuscripts
- Encryption in transit and, where feasible, at rest
- Restricted contact details
- Reviewer anonymity
- Backups
- Security logs
- Account deactivation
- Compliance with applicable Philippine data-protection and institutional policies

18. DASHBOARD REQUIREMENTS

Role	Dashboard Elements
Author	My Submissions, Drafts, Revisions Due, Decisions, Messages, Published Articles
Reviewer	Invitations, Active Reviews, Deadlines, Completed Reviews
Section Editor	Assigned Manuscripts, Screening Queue, Invitations, Overdue Reviews, Decisions Pending
Managing Editor	All Submissions, Technical Checks, Missing Files,

	Communications, Production Queue, Issue Progress
Editor-in-Chief	All Manuscripts, Final Decisions, Appeals, Ethics Alerts, Accepted Articles, Issue Approval, Metrics

19. REPORTS AND MONITORING

- Submissions by month, issue, article type, and discipline
- Acceptance/rejection rates
- Time to first decision
- Time under review
- Reviewer response and completion rates
- Overdue reviews
- Revisions received
- Accepted manuscripts awaiting production
- Published articles
- Ethics and integrity cases
- Appeals and complaints
- Publication schedule

20. RECOMMENDED SYSTEM MODULES

Module	Core Functions
User and Role Management	Registration, profiles, permissions, role assignment
Submission Management	Metadata, declarations, file upload, validation
Editorial Assignment	Assign editors and sections
Peer Review Management	Reviewer database, invitations, forms, deadlines
Decision Management	Recommendations, final decisions, letters
Revision Management	Revision rounds and version control
Production Management	Copyediting, layout, proofreading, approval
Issue Management	Volume, issue, article order, schedule
Communication Center	Templates, notifications, message history
Reports and Analytics	Workflow and publication statistics
Ethics and Integrity	Conflicts, ethics, similarity, cases
Repository and Archive	Final files, metadata, versions
Public Journal Website	Published articles, guidelines, board, issues

21. ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA FOR THE DEVELOPER

- Author can submit the four-file package.
- Required files and declarations are validated.
- Title Page and Cover Letter are hidden from reviewers.
- Reviewers access only anonymized materials.
- Section Editor can screen and invite reviewers.
- Reviewer can accept/decline and submit a report.
- Section Editor can recommend a decision.
- Editor-in-Chief can release final decision.
- Author can submit revisions without deleting earlier versions.
- Notifications are sent for key events.

- Accepted manuscripts can move through production.
- Audit trail is preserved.
- Unauthorized access is blocked.
- Reports can be generated.
- Public site displays only approved published content.

22. ITEMS FOR EDITORIAL BOARD APPROVAL

Policy Item	Decision Needed
Article types	Which formats are accepted?
Word/page limits	Maximum length per article type
Abstract	Structured/unstructured and word limit
Keywords	Required number
Citation style	Approved style
Peer review	Double-blind or another model
Reviewers	Minimum number
Deadlines	Review and revision periods
Plagiarism	Threshold and procedure
AI policy	Permitted use and disclosure
Copyright/license	Author-retained or transferred; license
DOI	Registration and assignment process
Data availability	Required statement and exceptions
Appeals	Grounds and timeline
Retention	Data and file retention period

23. APPENDICES AND TEMPLATES

Appendix A. Author Submission Checklist

- Cover Letter uploaded
- Title Page uploaded
- Anonymous Manuscript uploaded
- Supplementary Materials uploaded, if applicable
- Metadata complete
- All authors entered in correct order
- Corresponding author identified
- Ethics, funding, conflict, AI, and data statements completed as applicable
- Declarations accepted
- Manuscript anonymized
- Files readable and correctly named

Appendix B. Reviewer Report Template

Section	Prompt
General Assessment	Summarize contribution and overall quality.
Strengths	Identify important strengths.
Major Concerns	Identify issues requiring action.
Methodology	Is the design appropriate and sufficiently described?
Results	Are results accurate and clear?
Discussion	Are findings appropriately interpreted?
Ethics	Are ethical requirements addressed?

Presentation	Are language, tables, and figures acceptable?
Comments to Author	Constructive comments for the author.
Confidential Comments	Information for the editor.
Recommendation	Select recommendation.

Appendix C. Recommended Author-Facing Instructions

To submit a manuscript, prepare the following files:

- File 1 — Cover Letter
- File 2 — Title Page
- File 3 — Anonymous Manuscript
- File 4 — Supplementary Materials, if applicable

The Cover Letter and Title Page contain identifying information and are accessible only to the editorial team. The Anonymous Manuscript must not contain author names, affiliations, acknowledgments, or other information that may reveal author identity. Supplementary Materials should be uploaded only when relevant or required.

FINAL IMPLEMENTATION NOTE

This guide should be used alongside the SKRJET Guide for Authors, Editorial and Publication Ethics Policy, Reviewer Guidelines, and journal website content. The developer should convert each role into user stories, screen requirements, database fields, workflow rules, notification triggers, and acceptance tests. The Editorial Board should validate the proposed workflow before launch. Provisions marked [TO BE APPROVED] are recommendations and are not binding until formally adopted.